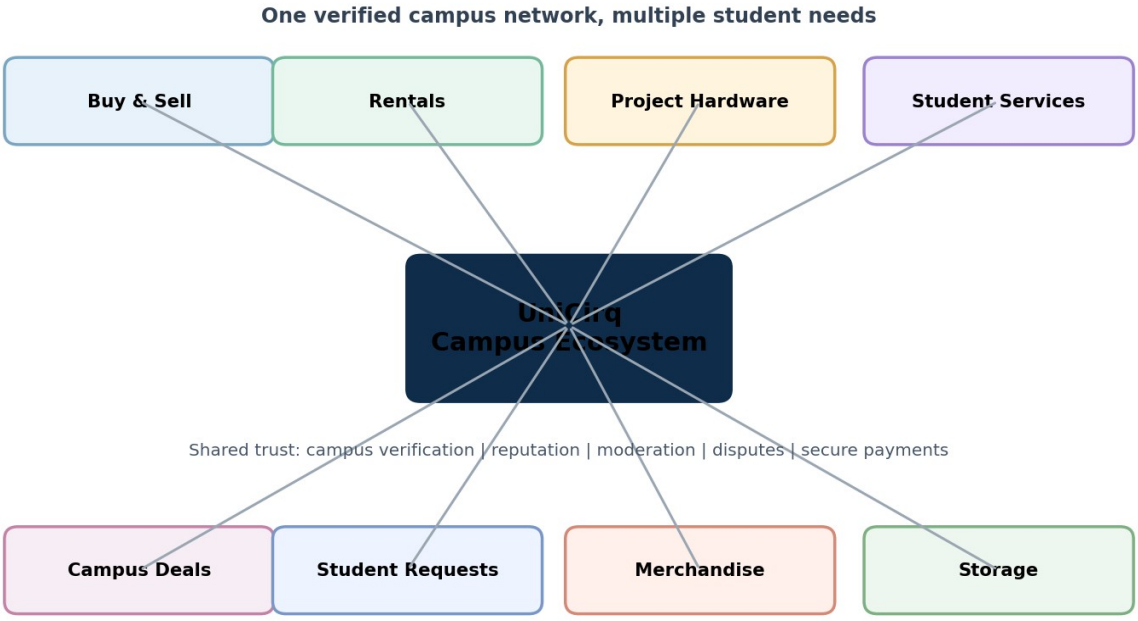
UniCirq

Product, Business, Architecture, Security, Legal & Privacy Blueprint

Version 3.0 | India-focused | Updated 27 September 2026



Purpose of this document

A founder-ready blueprint for a campus marketplace combining used goods, rentals, project hardware, student services, storage and merchandise. It integrates the product model with defensive security, legal structure and a draft privacy policy. It is not legal, tax or regulatory advice; counsel/CA review is required before launch.

Prepared as a planning document - replace all bracketed placeholders before publication.

0. Contents & document status

Version 3 incorporates the finalized UniCirq brand, realistic single-campus unit economics, seasonal hardware/storage assumptions, role-based Student/Business/Admin portals, and dashboard UX directions, while preserving the legal, privacy and security blueprint.

- 1. Executive summary
- 2. Business model and marketplace boundaries
- 3. User roles and feature catalogue
- 4. Transaction models and monetization
- 5. Product journeys and marketplace mechanics
- 6. Technical architecture
- 7. Core data model and service boundaries
- 8. Security architecture
- 9. Threat model and student-attack scenarios
- 10. Fraud, trust and safety controls
- 11. Legal architecture by product line
- 12. India legal and regulatory framework
- 13. Tax, payments and accounting considerations
- 14. Contracts and policy stack
- 15. Privacy-by-design architecture
- 16. Draft Privacy Policy
- 17. Incident response and evidence handling
- 18. Compliance roadmap and launch checklist
- 19. MVP-to-scale implementation roadmap
- 20. Official references and review notes
- 21. UniCirq brand and product identity
- 22. Role-based portals and login architecture
- 23. Revised campus unit economics and seasonality
- 24. Product/dashboard information architecture
- 25. UI theme directions and dashboard references
- 26. Version 3 decisions and launch priorities

> **Legal status snapshot**
> The DPDP Act and Rules are under phased commencement. As of 27 September 2026, the November 2025 commencement notification has brought specified provisions into force immediately, while additional provisions commence after one year and many core processing/rights obligations after eighteen months. The product should be engineered now to the stronger end-state standard rather than waiting for each phase. [R1-R2]

1. Executive summary

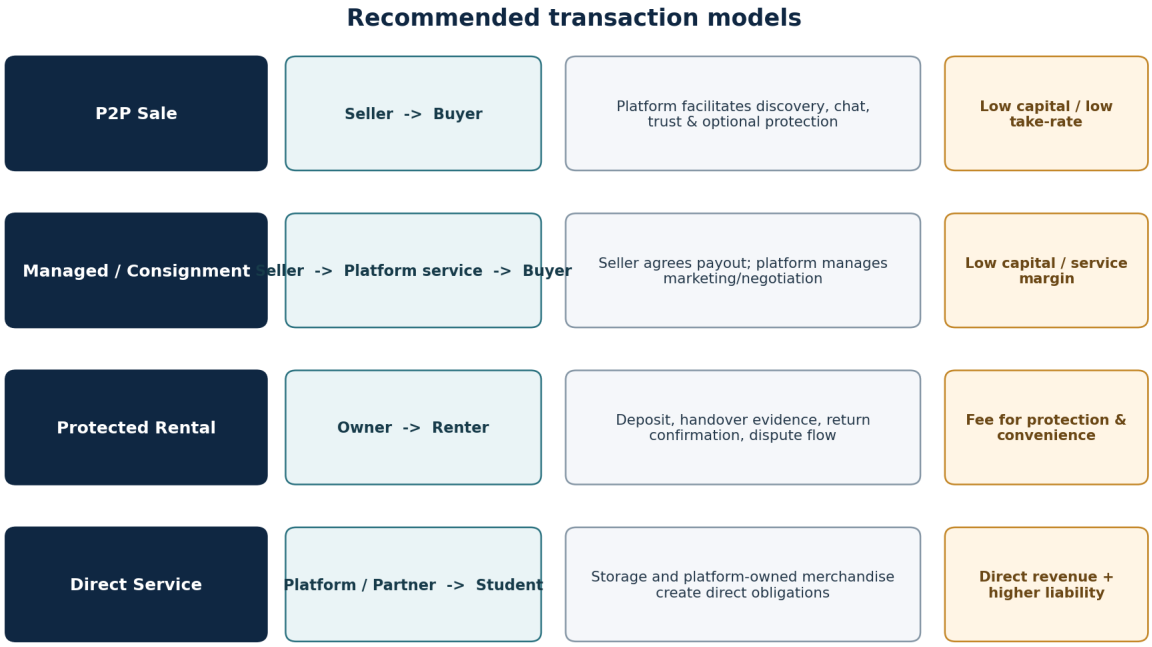
UniCirq is a verified campus ecosystem where students can buy and sell used products, rent equipment, rent engineering/project hardware, hire tutors or freelancers, store luggage, order merchandise, discover campus deals and post requests for items or services. Its strongest advantage is not a single feature; it is the density of a trusted student network that supports several campus needs in one account.

The commercial model deliberately avoids depending on hidden commissions or large percentage take-rates on small student transactions. Basic P2P discovery should remain free or nearly free; rentals should use small protection/service fees; and stronger monetization should come from managed selling, services, merchandise, seasonal storage, campus-business advertising/partnerships and optional promotion.

The recommended legal model is equally modular. The platform should be a facilitator for P2P transactions, an explicitly contracted service provider for managed sales, a facilitator for peer rentals and student services, and a direct service provider only where it truly takes custody or becomes the seller (for example storage or platform-owned merchandise).

Design principle	Recommendation	Why it matters
Trust before monetization	Free/low-friction P2P; monetize protected or operational services	Reduces off-platform leakage and accelerates network liquidity
No hidden economics	Disclose fees, managed-sale payout logic and total checkout price	Reduces consumer-law and trust risk
Do not hold money casually	Use an authorised payment provider with marketplace settlement capabilities	Avoids turning the startup into an unstructured payment intermediary
Minimum necessary data	Verify students without retaining unnecessary ID documents	Reduces privacy and breach impact
Defense in depth	Treat technically skilled users as a realistic threat model	Campus environments create concentrated abuse and testing pressure
Separate contracts	Different Terms for P2P, rental, managed sale, storage and services	The platform role and liability materially differ by feature

2. Business model and marketplace boundaries



The platform should support multiple transaction modes instead of forcing every interaction into one commission structure. This avoids the problem where two students discover each other on the platform and then bypass checkout to avoid a fee.

Mode	Ownership / custody	Platform responsibility	Suggested monetization
P2P used-goods sale	Seller keeps ownership until sale; platform does not take custody	Discovery, verification, chat, reputation, optional protection	Free listing + featured/urgent listing fees
Managed / consignment sale	Seller retains title unless contract says otherwise; platform markets under agreed payout	Listing optimisation, negotiation, buyer handling, optional payment workflow	Transparent service margin or fixed fee
Peer rental	Owner owns item; renter receives temporary possession	Booking, deposit logic, evidence, return flow, dispute process	Protection/service fee
Student services	Provider performs service for student customer	Discovery, scope/milestones, payment/dispute tools	Service fee or provider subscription
Storage	Platform/partner physically holds goods	Custody, inventory controls, access, return, loss/damage handling	Monthly/seasonal storage charges
Merchandise	Platform or authorised partner sells goods	Direct seller obligations, returns/refunds, quality and IP permissions	Gross product margin

3. User roles and feature catalogue

3.1 User roles

Role	Main capabilities	Special controls
Student buyer	Search, chat, offers, purchases, rental bookings, service requests	Verified account; risk scoring; dispute access
Student seller/owner	Create listings, accept offers, manage availability, handover/return	Ownership declaration; listing moderation; payout verification
Tutor/freelancer	Create service profile, quote jobs, milestones, deliver work	Academic integrity rules; service categories; quality reviews
Club / campus organisation	Merch campaigns, club marketplace, bulk requests	Authorised representative verification; IP approval
Local business partner	Sponsored listings, rentals, fulfilment or storage partnership	KYB/merchant checks; commercial contract
Moderator	Review reports, listings, chat flags and disputes	Least privilege; audited actions; no raw payment credentials
Admin / operations	Policy, escalations, payouts, partner management	Strong MFA; step-up auth; dual control for sensitive actions
Security / compliance	Incident response, log review, legal holds, access review	Separate privileged roles; immutable audit logs

3.2 Core features

Buy & Sell Marketplace

- Used books, electronics, furniture, cycles, calculators, hostel goods and other approved categories.
- Filters by campus, category, price, condition and availability.
- Offers, reservation state, listing expiration, save/favourite, report listing.
- Leaving-campus bundles for graduating students.

Rentals

- Daily/weekly pricing, availability calendar, deposits, late fees and return confirmation.
- Pre-handover condition photos, QR/OTP handover, return evidence and dispute window.
- Optional protection tiers for higher-value items.

Project Hardware

- Arduino, ESP32, Raspberry Pi, sensors, motors, multimeters, robotics kits, cameras and approved lab gear.
- Compatibility/spec fields, kit contents checklist and replacement value.
- Special damage/consumable rules and return inspection.

Student Services

- Tutoring, mentoring, design, video editing, photography, coding assistance, website development and event services.
- Scope, price, delivery date, milestones and review flow.
- Academic integrity controls: prohibit impersonation, exam assistance or completion of assessed work.

Storage

- Booking by box/suitcase/cycle category, pickup appointment, QR inventory tags and scheduled return.
- Declared value, prohibited-item list, storage photos, chain-of-custody log.
- Partner model can reduce initial warehouse capital.

Merchandise

- Pre-order based college/club hoodies, T-shirts, jerseys, stickers and accessories.
- Campaign minimum quantity, size collection, order window and fulfilment tracking.
- Written permission for protected college/club branding before sale.

Student Requests

- Students post what they need: item, rental, service or hardware, budget and deadline.
- Relevant sellers/providers can respond; anti-spam and duplicate controls.

Trust Layer

- College verification, profile reputation, completed-transaction count, reviews, reports and dispute history.
- Only verified transactions should count toward protected badges or platform guarantees.

4. Transaction models and monetization

Business line	Base fee idea	Why users stay on-platform
P2P marketplace	0% transaction fee initially; optional boosts around INR 19-49	Discovery, reputation, verified profiles and convenience
Managed sale	Illustrative fixed contribution/margin around INR 100-150 on ordinary campus items	Seller avoids negotiation and repetitive messages
Rentals	Small flat protection fee or roughly 5-7% effective take-rate	Deposits, evidence, return workflow and disputes
Hardware rental	Small flat/protection fee; seasonal around practical/project periods	Higher loss risk makes verification/protection valuable; demand is concentrated
Student services	Illustrative 7-10% fee where payment protection adds value	Milestones, payment confidence and dispute support
Storage	Seasonal monthly charge / partner margin; typically used 1-2 times a year	Physical custody and scheduled pickup/return
Merchandise	Illustrative product contribution around INR 50-100 per unit	Bulk procurement and licensed/approved designs
Clubs / businesses	Monthly promotion, sponsored placement or campaign fee	Access to a campus-specific audience

Pricing integrity rule

Do not secretly show a buyer a higher price while implying it is the seller price. For managed sales, the seller should expressly agree to a payout or service fee structure and the buyer should see an accurate total price. Avoid drip pricing, forced add-ons and misleading urgency. Consumer-protection dark-pattern guidance specifically addresses deceptive interface patterns. [R5]

5. Product journeys and marketplace mechanics

5.1 P2P sale

1. Seller verifies account and creates listing.
2. Listing passes automated checks and, when required, moderation.
3. Buyer searches, views seller reputation and starts chat or makes an offer.
4. Parties agree a price. Optional protected checkout may be offered, but direct P2P can remain allowed if your business model does not depend on commission.
5. Handover is confirmed and both parties can review each other.

5.2 Managed / consignment sale

6. Seller chooses “Sell for me” and states expected payout or accepts a quote.
7. Seller agrees managed-sale terms, including platform authority to market, negotiate and determine the buyer-facing price within agreed parameters.
8. Item stays with seller or is moved to a controlled pickup point depending on the model.
9. Platform manages enquiries and secures payment through the payment provider.
10. Handover confirmation triggers seller payout under the agreed terms.

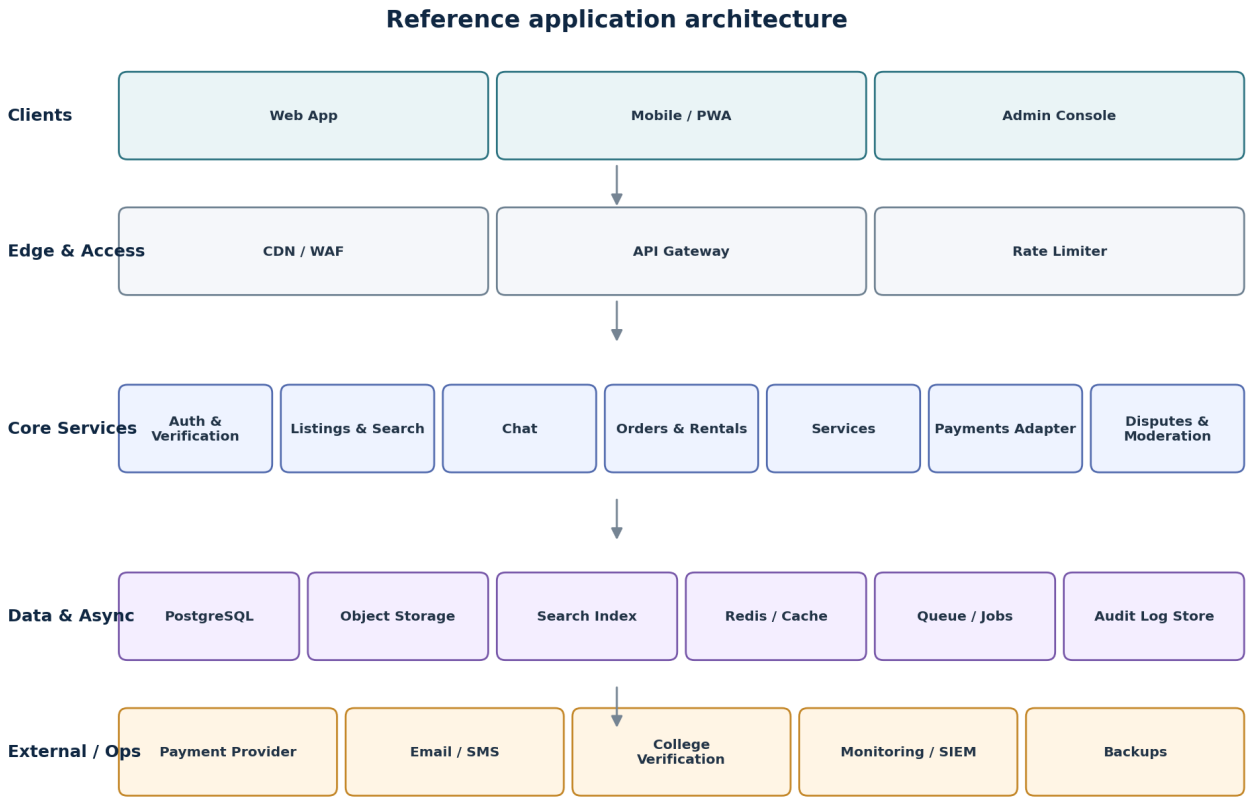
5.3 Rental

11. Owner lists item, rental price, deposit/replacement value and availability.
12. Renter books dates and completes any required verification.
13. System records pre-handover condition evidence and issues handover code.
14. At return, owner records condition and confirms return.
15. Deposit/protection workflow releases or holds disputed amount in accordance with payment-provider capabilities and rental terms.

5.4 Student services

16. Customer posts requirement or chooses provider.
17. Scope, price, deliverable and due date are recorded before work starts.
18. Milestone or completion evidence is uploaded through the platform.
19. Customer accepts, requests permitted revision or raises a dispute.
20. Provider receives settlement through the payment provider.

6. Technical architecture



A modular monolith is usually the best starting architecture for a student-founded MVP: one deployable backend with strong module boundaries, a relational database and asynchronous jobs. It is simpler to secure and operate than premature microservices, while still allowing later extraction of search, chat, payments or notifications if scale demands it.

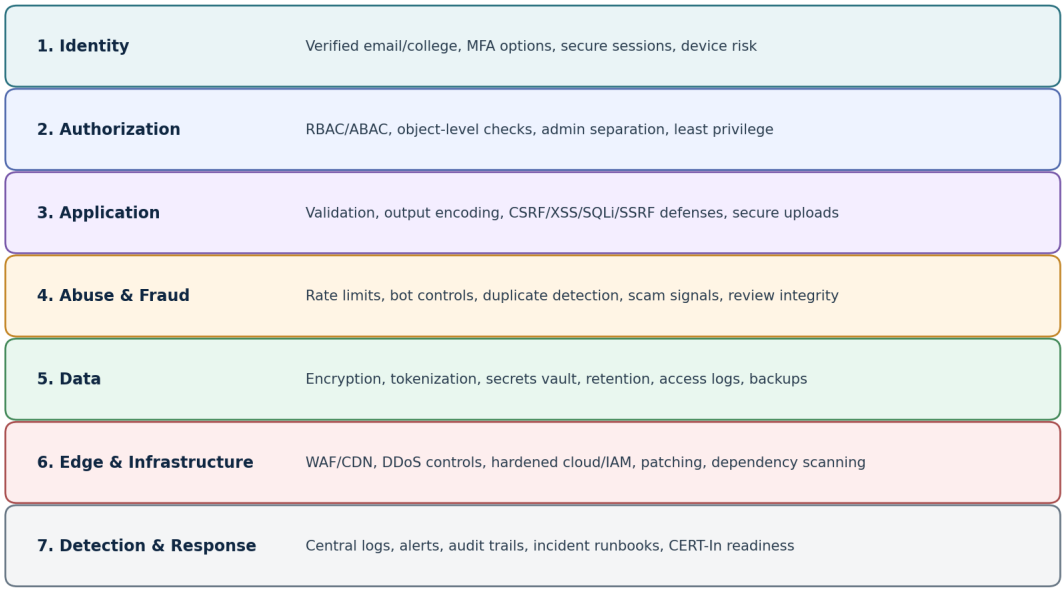
Layer	Recommended responsibility	Notes
Frontend	Next.js/React web app or PWA; admin console separated logically	Use server-side validation too; frontend checks are not security controls
API / backend	Auth, listings, offers, bookings, services, disputes, moderation	Central authorization middleware plus object-level checks per route
Database	PostgreSQL	Transactional consistency for orders, rentals, payouts and disputes
Cache / rate limiting	Redis or managed equivalent	Sessions, queues, throttles, short-lived locks
Search	Database search initially; dedicated index later	Do not expose unmoderated private fields into search index
Object storage	Images, dispute evidence, invoices, policy versions	Private-by-default buckets; signed URLs; malware checks
Async jobs	Notifications, image processing, fraud checks, settlement reconciliation	Idempotent jobs with retry/dead-letter handling
Observability	Metrics, traces, application/security logs	PII redaction and strict access controls

7. Core data model and service boundaries

Entity	Key fields / relations	Security / legal notes
User	id, verified status, campus, roles, risk state, timestamps	Do not use sequential public IDs for authorization assumptions
VerificationRecord	method, provider reference, result, expiry, minimal metadata	Avoid long-term storage of raw IDs unless necessary
Listing	owner, category, price, condition, campus, state	Ownership declaration; prohibited-items checks
Offer	listing, buyer, amount, expiry, status	Only participants may view; protect against IDOR
Order	buyer, seller/provider, amount, fees, status, provider payment ref	Immutable financial event history
RentalBooking	owner, renter, dates, deposit/replacement value, handover/return status	Condition evidence and dispute deadlines
ServiceJob	customer, provider, scope, milestones, delivery evidence	Academic integrity classification
Conversation / Message	participants, listing/job reference, moderation flags	Access checks on every message/thread request
Review	reviewer, subject, transaction id, rating, text	One review per eligible transaction; anti-retaliation controls
Dispute	transaction, reason, evidence, assigned moderator, outcome	Evidence retention and audited moderator actions
StorageItem	owner, booking, tag, declared value, custody state	Chain of custody; physical inventory reconciliations
AuditEvent	actor, action, target, IP/device metadata, outcome	Append-only or tamper-evident storage

8. Security architecture

Defense-in-depth security model



The app should assume that some users will intentionally probe it. A college network can concentrate technically skilled users who know each other, can coordinate abuse and can repeatedly test business logic. Security therefore must include both conventional application security and marketplace-specific anti-abuse controls.

Authentication and account security

- Email/phone verification and college verification as separate trust signals.
- Argon2id or bcrypt for passwords; never store plaintext or reversible password encryption.
- Optional TOTP/passkey MFA for students; mandatory MFA for moderators/admins.
- Short-lived access tokens or secure server sessions; HttpOnly, Secure, SameSite cookies where applicable.
- Rate-limit login, OTP and password reset; detect credential-stuffing patterns.
- Step-up authentication for payout changes, account recovery, admin actions and sensitive profile changes.

Authorization

- RBAC for broad roles plus object-level authorization on every resource.
- Never trust user-supplied owner_id, seller_id, price, fee or payout fields.
- Prevent IDOR/BOLA by checking actor relationship to every listing, conversation, order, dispute and file.
- Separate finance, moderation and system-admin privileges.

Input/output security

- Parameterized queries/ORM to prevent SQL injection.
- Contextual output encoding and strict HTML sanitization to prevent stored/reflected XSS.
- CSRF tokens or same-site protections for cookie-authenticated state-changing requests.
- SSRF protection: deny arbitrary URL fetching; allowlist if server-side fetch is required.
- Strict schema validation for API inputs; reject unexpected fields.

File-upload security

- Allowlist MIME types and verify file signatures, not just extensions.

- Strip metadata from uploaded images where reasonable.
- Store uploads outside executable paths and serve through private/object storage.
- Malware scanning for documents/archives; reject active content when not required.
- Generate derivative images server-side instead of serving originals directly where possible.

Payments and financial integrity

- Use provider-generated payment references; never trust frontend “payment success”.
- Verify signed webhooks and reconcile provider settlement reports.
- Idempotency keys for payment/order actions to prevent duplicate charges/credits.
- Never store raw card credentials; use provider tokenization/hosted checkout.
- All fee/payout calculations performed server-side from authoritative price snapshots.

Infrastructure

- CDN/WAF, DDoS protection, TLS everywhere, HSTS and secure headers.
- Private databases, restrictive security groups/firewalls and least-privilege cloud IAM.
- Separate production/staging; no production secrets in developer laptops or source control.
- Secrets manager with rotation; CI/CD protected branches and review.
- Automated dependency/SCA scanning and critical patch SLAs.

Logging and monitoring

- Centralized security/application logs with PII minimization.
- Audit all admin/moderator access, role changes, payout changes and dispute outcomes.
- Alerts for impossible travel/device anomalies, mass scraping, enumeration and privilege failures.
- Preserve security evidence under defined retention/legal-hold rules.

9. Threat model and student-attack scenarios

Threat scenario	What attacker tries	Primary controls
Account takeover	Credential stuffing, OTP brute force, password-reset abuse	Rate limits, MFA, reset-token expiry, device/risk signals, alerting
IDOR / BOLA	Change order/listing/message IDs to access other users data	Server-side object authorization, opaque IDs, automated tests
Price tampering	Modify frontend amount or fee before checkout	Server-side price snapshots, signed checkout session, provider reconciliation
Fake payment proof	Upload edited UPI screenshot	Never treat screenshot as payment; provider status/webhook is authoritative
Stored XSS	Put scripts in listing/chat/service descriptions	Sanitize/encode; CSP; no raw HTML
SQL injection	Craft search/filter or API payloads	Parameterized queries, ORM discipline, WAF secondary control
Malicious uploads	Upload executable/polyglot files as images/docs	Signature checks, scanning, private object storage, non-executable serving
Scraping / enumeration	Harvest student profiles, phone numbers or listings	Minimize exposed PII, rate limiting, pagination limits, bot controls
Spam / scam rings	Multiple accounts coordinate fake listings/reviews	Device/graph signals, verification, transaction-bound reviews, velocity limits
Review manipulation	Self-dealing or retaliatory reviews	Only completed transaction participants; delayed/reveal-together options
Deposit abuse	Owner falsely claims damage; renter disputes return	Pre/post condition evidence, deadlines, structured dispute rules
Admin abuse	Privileged user views data or changes payouts	MFA, least privilege, dual control, immutable audit logs, access reviews
DDoS / stress testing	Flood login/search/chat endpoints	CDN/WAF, edge rate limits, autoscaling, circuit breakers
Business-logic race	Claim same rental slot, double-spend coupon or repeated refund	Database constraints, locks/transactions, idempotency and state machines

> **Security rule for launch**
> A penetration test is useful, but it does not replace secure design. Before public campus launch, perform automated dependency scanning, API authorization tests, manual business-logic tests, secret scanning, backup restore testing and a focused external security review if the budget permits.

10. Fraud, trust and safety controls

Abuse category	Controls
Fake identity / impersonation	College verification, duplicate-account signals, verified badges with expiry, manual escalation for suspicious accounts
Stolen goods	Seller ownership declaration, report/stolen-item workflow, serial number fields for selected categories, cooperation process for lawful requests
Scam listings	Price anomaly signals, image reuse detection, new-account velocity limits, high-risk category moderation
Off-platform pressure	Do not rely on blocking contact details; provide meaningful protection and reputation only for protected transactions
Harassment in chat	Report/block, keyword/risk classifiers where appropriate, moderator tooling, evidence retention and escalation
Fraudulent disputes	Structured evidence, transaction timeline, moderator decision codes, appeal/escalation process
Prohibited products	Category allowlist/denylist, keyword/image moderation, repeat-offender suspension
Academic misconduct	Clear allowed/prohibited services, report pathway, provider sanctions, no “complete my exam/graded assignment” positioning

11. Legal architecture by product line

Legal role changes by product line

P2P used goods	Marketplace / intermediary	Seller owns item; buyer contracts with seller
Managed sale	Marketplace + agent/consignment service	Seller authorizes marketing; agreed payout terms
Peer rental	Rental facilitator	Owner and renter remain transaction principals
Student services	Services marketplace	Provider and customer contract; platform facilitates
Storage	Direct storage provider / bailee	Platform or storage partner takes custody of goods
Own merchandise	Direct seller	Platform/partner is seller; consumer obligations apply directly

The platform should not describe itself as “only an intermediary” across every feature. Legal characterization follows what the business actually does. If the platform takes custody of luggage, sells its own merchandise or buys/resells an item, its obligations are materially different from a listing-only marketplace.

Feature	Recommended legal structure	Key contract/policy
P2P sale	Buyer and seller are principals; platform facilitates	Marketplace Terms + Seller Rules + Buyer Rules
Managed sale	Seller appoints platform to perform defined sale/marketing services	Managed Sale / Consignment Agreement
Rental	Owner and renter contract; platform provides booking/protection workflow	Rental Terms + Condition/Deposit Policy
Student services	Customer and provider contract; platform facilitates	Services Marketplace Terms + Academic Integrity Policy
Storage	Platform or named storage partner accepts custody	Storage Agreement + liability/declared value terms
Merchandise	Platform/authorised merchant is seller	Sale Terms + Refund/Return Policy + IP permissions
Club campaigns	Platform facilitates group ordering under club authorization	Club/Organisation Agreement + brand/IP approval

12. India legal and regulatory framework

India-focused planning summary; have an Indian lawyer/CA validate the final model and policy wording before launch.

12.1 Business entity and governance

For a scalable venture that will sign campus/vendor agreements, process meaningful revenue or raise investment, the founders should consider operating through an incorporated entity rather than personally. A Private Limited Company is commonly used for venture-backed startups; an LLP is another structure with different governance and fundraising implications. Incorporation and filings are handled through the Ministry of Corporate Affairs. [R12]

- Founder agreement / shareholders agreement covering equity, vesting, IP assignment, decision rights and founder departures.
- Company-owned domain, repositories, cloud accounts, payment accounts and trademarks rather than personal ownership.
- Board/authorized signatory controls for material contracts and banking.

12.2 Consumer protection and e-commerce

The Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020 apply broadly to goods and services bought or sold over digital/electronic networks and cover marketplace and inventory models, subject to their scope and exceptions. The 2021 amendment introduced, for covered company e-commerce entities, a resident nodal officer or alternate senior designated functionary for compliance. Marketplace disclosures and grievance handling should be designed into the product from launch. [R3-R4]

- Publish accurate seller/service information required by applicable rules.
- Maintain a visible grievance channel and complaint tracking.
- Use clear return/refund/cancellation terms per transaction type.
- Do not represent platform-provided guarantees more broadly than the actual service.

12.3 Dark patterns and transparent pricing

The CCPA Guidelines for Prevention and Regulation of Dark Patterns, 2023 define deceptive interface practices that impair consumer autonomy, including concepts such as drip pricing, forced action, basket sneaking, false urgency and bait-and-switch. Hidden fees or misleading price presentation should therefore be avoided. [R5]

- Show the total payable amount before commitment.
- Do not preselect paid protection or donations.
- Do not invent countdown timers or scarcity claims.
- Managed-sale pricing should be contractually authorised and not misrepresented as the seller's net payout.

12.4 Payments and settlement

RBI regulates payment aggregators and related settlement structures. Authorised non-bank payment aggregators are subject to escrow and other requirements. For an early-stage marketplace, the safer operational pattern is to use an authorised payment provider with marketplace/merchant settlement functionality instead of collecting buyer funds into the startup's ordinary bank account and manually forwarding them to sellers. [R6]

> **Payment architecture principle**
> Buyer funds should flow through a compliant payment-provider setup. The startup backend should receive status/webhook events and calculate platform fees, but should not create an informal "wallet" or hold customer money without specific legal/regulatory review.

12.5 GST and e-commerce operator obligations

Section 52 of the CGST Act creates a tax-collection-at-source framework for electronic commerce operators where taxable supplies are made through the platform by other suppliers and consideration is collected by the operator. The exact registration, TCS, reporting and seller-registration consequences depend on transaction type, who collects consideration and current notifications/exemptions. [R7]

- Have a CA map each flow: P2P used item, recurring commercial seller, tutor/freelancer, storage, own merchandise and managed sale.
- Maintain transaction-level tax classification and invoice/receipt records.
- Do not hard-code tax assumptions in product logic without configurable rules.

12.6 Income-tax TDS under section 194-O

Section 194-O addresses sales or services facilitated by an e-commerce operator. The official Income Tax Department text currently states a 0.1% deduction rate on the gross amount, with a specified threshold for qualifying individual/HUF participants who furnish PAN/Aadhaar; it also deems certain direct buyer-to-participant payments to be included for this purpose. Tax implementation requires CA review because facts and exemptions matter. [R8]

12.7 Minors and contractual capacity

The Majority Act states that a person domiciled in India generally attains majority at 18. Because college communities may include users under 18, the MVP should either restrict transactional features to 18+ users or obtain specific legal advice for a guardian-based mechanism. [R9]

12.8 Data protection and privacy

The DPDP Act, 2023 and DPDP Rules, 2025 are subject to phased commencement. The 13 November 2025 commencement notification brought specified institutional and miscellaneous provisions into force immediately; selected provisions commence one year later, while many core processing, consent, rights and obligations commence eighteen months after publication. The Rules use the same phased pattern. As of 27 September 2026, the one-year and eighteen-month phases have not yet fully arrived. [R1-R2]

- Design notices to be standalone, clear and specific about categories of personal data and purposes.
- Build consent withdrawal, access/correction/erasure workflow capability now.
- Maintain a grievance channel and a mechanism to verify requests.
- Collect the minimum student verification data necessary and define retention periods.
- Plan breach detection, response and notification processes rather than improvising after an incident.

12.9 Intermediary / user-generated content

A marketplace with listings, profiles and chat hosts user-generated content. The Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021, as updated, are therefore relevant to the extent the service qualifies and seeks applicable intermediary protections. Your exact status and due-diligence duties should be reviewed by counsel as the feature set evolves. [R10]

- Publish user rules and prohibited-content categories.
- Provide report/block and grievance channels.
- Maintain an operational process for lawful notices and orders.
- Preserve evidence when needed instead of deleting all reported content immediately.

12.10 Cyber incident and log obligations

CERT-In has issued directions under section 70B of the IT Act relating to cyber incident reporting and information-security practices. Covered entities should maintain readiness for incident reporting, designated contact points and applicable log-retention requirements. [R11]

12.11 Rentals and storage - bailment

Chapter IX of the Indian Contract Act defines bailment as delivery of goods for a purpose with an obligation to return or otherwise dispose of them according to directions. This concept is particularly relevant when the platform or storage partner physically takes custody of student property and can also inform rental terms. [R13]

- Record condition and item contents at handover.
- Define ordinary wear, damage, loss, late return and replacement-value rules.
- For storage, define prohibited items, declared value, access controls, custody chain and maximum liability subject to legal review.

12.12 Trademarks, college logos and merchandise

College names, logos, club marks and third-party brands may be protected under trademark and copyright law. The Trade Marks Act, 1999 is a core statute. Do not market merchandise as “official” or use protected branding without written authorization from the relevant rights holder. [R14]

12.13 Prohibited/restricted items and safety

- Maintain a prohibited-items policy covering unlawful, stolen, counterfeit and regulated goods.
- Create enhanced controls for categories that may trigger additional licensing or safety obligations.
- Require sellers to declare ownership and legal right to sell/rent.
- Provide fast takedown and evidence-preservation processes for credible stolen-goods reports.

12.14 Campus operations and permissions

- Online operation does not automatically authorize physical stalls, lockers, storage points or advertising inside a college.
- Obtain written permission/MoU before using campus space, institutional logos or “official partner” claims.
- For pickup/storage operations, check local premises, fire-safety, insurance and labour/vendor requirements with counsel/CA/local authority as applicable.

13. Tax, payments and accounting considerations

Flow	Who should invoice / receipt	Accounting / tax question to resolve
P2P used item	Usually seller to buyer where applicable; platform separately bills paid boost/protection	Is seller acting personally vs commercially? Does operator collect consideration?
Managed sale	Depends on agency/consignment structure	Is platform fee separate or margin? Who is supplier to buyer?
Peer rental	Owner/rental supplier vs platform fee	GST classification, deposit treatment, cancellation/late fees
Student service	Service provider vs platform fee	TDS/GST depending on facts and thresholds
Storage	Platform/storage partner	Direct service revenue; GST and local operating costs
Merchandise	Platform/merchant seller	Inventory purchase, GST invoice, returns and COGS

- Use separate ledger accounts for platform fees, seller/provider payable balances, refunds, taxes and payment-provider fees.
- Reconcile every payment-provider settlement to internal order IDs.
- Do not mix founder personal UPI/bank accounts with marketplace operations.
- Make tax rules configurable; legal rates/thresholds change.

14. Contracts and policy stack

Document	Purpose	Before launch?
Terms of Service	Master relationship, eligibility, account rules, disclaimers, suspension, disputes	Yes
Privacy Policy	What personal data is collected, why, sharing, retention, rights and contact	Yes
Marketplace Seller Terms	Ownership, listing accuracy, prohibited goods, handover	Yes
Buyer Terms	Offers, inspections, protected checkout, refunds/disputes	Yes
Managed Sale / Consignment Agreement	Seller payout, pricing authority, cancellation, possession and liability	Before feature launch
Rental Terms	Deposit, damage, late return, evidence and replacement value	Before rentals
Services Marketplace Terms	Scope, milestones, payment and provider/customer responsibilities	Before services
Academic Integrity Policy	Allowed tutoring vs prohibited assessed-work completion	Before services
Storage Agreement	Custody, prohibited items, declared value, loss/damage, access and return	Before storage
Refund/Cancellation Policy	Rules per transaction type	Yes
Prohibited Items Policy	Restricted/unlawful listings and enforcement	Yes
Community/Chat Guidelines	Harassment, spam, scams, moderation	Yes
Grievance Policy	How complaints are submitted, tracked and escalated	Yes
Club/College MoU	Campus space, official branding, campaigns, responsibilities	As partnerships begin
IP / Merchandise Authorization	Permission to use logos/marks/designs	Before branded merch

15. Privacy-by-design architecture

Privacy should be implemented as a data architecture, not only as a policy page. The app should know what data it collects, why it needs it, who can access it, how long it is retained and how it is deleted or anonymised.

Data category	Examples	Purpose	Recommended retention principle
Account	Name, email, phone, campus, username	Account, communication, verification	While account active + defined post-closure period
Verification	College email, verification result, limited ID metadata	Trust and fraud prevention	Prefer status/token over raw document; short retention for raw evidence
Marketplace	Listings, offers, orders, bookings, service jobs	Provide marketplace functionality	Transaction records retained per legal/accounting needs
Messages	Chat content and attachments	Transaction communication, safety and disputes	Defined window; longer only for disputes/legal hold
Payments	Provider references, amount, status, settlement IDs	Payment reconciliation, fraud, tax/accounting	Per statutory/accounting requirements; no raw card data
Security	IP, device/session, login events, abuse signals	Protect accounts/platform	Security retention schedule; access restricted
Support/disputes	Reports, evidence, moderator decisions	Resolve complaints and defend claims	Case lifecycle + legal hold if necessary
Storage custody	Item photos, QR/tag, declared value, pickup/return evidence	Chain of custody	Booking lifecycle + dispute/accounting retention

15.1 Privacy engineering controls

- Data inventory and owner for every table/event/log stream.
- Purpose limitation: do not reuse verification data for advertising or unrelated profiling.
- Role-based access to PII; moderators see only what is needed for case handling.
- Separate high-sensitivity verification evidence from ordinary profile data.
- Automated retention jobs with deletion/anonymisation where legally permitted.
- Download/access/correction/deletion request workflow with identity verification and audit trail.
- Vendor register and data-processing terms for cloud, analytics, email/SMS, verification and payment providers.
- Do not place personal data in URLs, analytics event names, client logs or error traces.

16. Draft Privacy Policy

Template for publication after legal review and replacement of all placeholders. This draft is designed for an India-based student marketplace and anticipates the mature DPDP compliance state.

> **Before publishing**
> **Replace [Company Legal Name], UniCirq, [Registered Address], [Privacy Email], [Grievance Officer], [Grievance Contact], effective date, exact vendors and actual retention periods. Remove any data category or use that the real product does not perform.**

16.1 Who we are

This Privacy Policy explains how [Company Legal Name] ("UniCirq", "we", "us" or "our") collects, uses, shares, stores and protects personal data when you use our website, mobile/PWA experience, marketplace, rental, services, storage, merchandise, messaging, support and related features (collectively, the "Platform"). Our registered address is [Registered Address]. For privacy questions, contact [Privacy Email].

16.2 Scope

This Policy applies to students, buyers, sellers, renters, owners, tutors/freelancers, club representatives, business partners and other users of the Platform. Separate commercial agreements may apply to storage partners, merchants, colleges, clubs or other organisations. Where a separate agreement provides additional privacy information for a specific activity, both documents should be read together.

16.3 Personal data we collect

Depending on the features you use, we may collect: (a) account details such as name, username, email address, phone number, password credential hash and campus/college; (b) verification data such as college-email status, limited student-verification information and verification-provider references; (c) profile and marketplace data such as profile photo, ratings, listings, item photos, descriptions, offers, orders, rentals, availability, service profiles and reviews; (d) communications such as in-platform messages, support requests and dispute evidence; (e) payment and transaction data such as amount, payment status, refund status, settlement/payout reference and provider transaction identifiers; (f) security/technical data such as IP address, device/browser information, session events, login timestamps, risk signals and audit logs; (g) storage/fulfilment data such as item tags, declared value, pickup/return evidence and delivery/pickup details where those services are offered; and (h) preferences and consent records.

16.4 Data we try not to collect

We do not intend to store raw payment-card credentials. Payments should be processed through authorised payment providers. We also aim to avoid retaining copies of college IDs or identity documents longer than needed for verification, fraud review, dispute handling or applicable legal obligations. Users should not send passwords, full card details, government credentials or unrelated sensitive documents through chat.

16.5 How we collect data

We collect personal data directly from you when you register, create a listing, make an offer, book a rental, request/provide a service, use chat, contact support or submit evidence. We may also receive data from service providers such as payment processors, verification providers, communications vendors and security/fraud tools. We generate operational data when you use the Platform, such as login, device, security and transaction events.

16.6 Why we use personal data

We use personal data to: create and secure accounts; verify student or partner status; display listings and profiles; enable search, offers, bookings, chat, rentals, services, storage and merchandise; process or reconcile payments

through third-party providers; communicate transaction updates; prevent fraud, scams, prohibited listings and abuse; moderate content and investigate reports; resolve disputes; provide customer support; comply with applicable legal, tax, accounting and regulatory requirements; maintain audit/security logs; improve reliability and user experience; and send marketing communications where permitted and subject to available preference/consent controls.

16.7 Consent and choices

Where processing is based on consent, we will provide a clear notice describing the relevant personal data and purpose, and we will provide a way to withdraw consent that is reasonably comparable in ease to the way consent was given. Withdrawal will not affect processing already lawfully completed, and some data may still need to be retained or processed where permitted or required by law, including for fraud prevention, disputes, taxation, accounting or legal claims.

16.8 Marketplace visibility

Some information is visible to other Platform users because the marketplace cannot function without it. Depending on your settings and feature, this may include display name, profile photo, college/campus indicator, verification badge, ratings, transaction count, listing/service information and public reviews. We recommend that users do not post phone numbers, personal addresses, ID documents, financial information or other unnecessary personal data in public listing text or photos.

16.9 Messages and moderation

In-platform messages are intended for marketplace or service communication. We may process message metadata and, where reasonably necessary for safety, user reports, fraud prevention, legal compliance or dispute resolution, relevant message content. We may use automated signals to prioritize suspicious activity for review; material enforcement decisions should have appropriate human review/escalation processes where feasible.

16.10 Payments

Payments are processed by third-party payment service providers. We may receive transaction identifiers, amount, status, refund/settlement information and limited payer/payee metadata needed to operate the Platform, reconcile transactions, prevent fraud and meet legal/accounting obligations. We do not intend to store full card numbers, CVV or equivalent raw payment credentials on our own servers.

16.11 Verification

We may verify student, college, club or business status using email-domain verification, one-time codes, documents or third-party verification services. We will seek to retain the minimum verification information needed to prove the result, investigate fraud and satisfy applicable obligations. Where a raw verification document is collected, it should be protected with stricter access controls and deleted when no longer required.

16.12 Location and meetup information

The Platform may use campus, neighbourhood, pickup point or approximate location information to show relevant listings and coordinate handovers. We should not collect precise continuous device location unless a future feature genuinely requires it and an appropriate notice/permission flow is implemented. Users should avoid publishing home addresses in public listings.

16.13 How we share personal data

We may share personal data with: payment providers; cloud hosting and storage vendors; email/SMS/push providers; verification and fraud-prevention vendors; analytics/monitoring providers configured with privacy safeguards; delivery/storage/fulfilment partners where needed to provide the requested service; professional advisers and auditors; colleges/clubs only where there is an appropriate relationship and lawful purpose; and government, law-enforcement, courts or regulators when required or permitted by applicable law. We do not sell personal data as a standalone data-broker business.

16.14 Service providers and international processing

Some technology providers may process data from infrastructure located outside your state or outside India. We will use providers and contractual/technical safeguards intended to comply with applicable Indian data-protection requirements and any government restrictions that may apply to cross-border transfers. The exact vendor list should be maintained internally and disclosed where legally required or operationally appropriate.

16.15 Retention

We retain personal data only for as long as needed for the purposes described in this Policy, subject to legal, tax, accounting, fraud-prevention, dispute, security and evidence requirements. Different categories have different retention periods. For example, active account/profile data may be retained while the account remains active; transaction and accounting records may be retained for statutory periods; security logs are retained under a documented schedule; chat/dispute evidence may be retained for a defined period or longer under legal hold; and unnecessary raw verification documents should be deleted earlier than verification status records.

16.16 Security

We use technical and organisational safeguards designed to protect personal data, including encryption in transit, access controls, secure authentication, role-based permissions, logging, monitoring, vulnerability management, backups and incident-response processes. No internet service can guarantee absolute security. Users are responsible for protecting their passwords, one-time codes and devices and should report suspected account compromise promptly.

16.17 Your rights and requests

Subject to applicable law and the phased commencement of relevant provisions, users may have rights to obtain information about personal data processing, request correction/completion/updating, request erasure where applicable, withdraw consent, seek grievance redressal and nominate another individual to exercise rights in specified circumstances. We will provide an in-app or web process for requests and may verify identity before acting on a request. Certain requests may be limited where retention or processing is required or permitted by law.

16.18 Account deletion

Users may request account closure through [Account Settings / Support path]. Closing an account will remove or deactivate data that is no longer needed, but we may retain limited records where required for completed transactions, taxation/accounting, security, fraud prevention, disputes, legal claims or regulatory obligations. Public reviews or transaction history may be anonymised where appropriate rather than deleted if needed to preserve marketplace integrity.

16.19 Children / users under 18

The transactional Platform is intended for users who are at least 18 years old unless we launch a separately reviewed guardian-consent flow. If we learn that an ineligible minor has created a transactional account, we may restrict or close it and take appropriate steps regarding associated data. A future minor-access feature must be separately designed to comply with applicable law.

16.20 Cookies, local storage and analytics

We may use cookies or similar technologies for secure login, preferences, fraud prevention, performance and analytics. Non-essential analytics/marketing technologies should be controlled through an appropriate consent/preference mechanism where required. Security and authentication cookies may be necessary for the service to function.

16.21 Fraud, safety and enforcement

We may use account, transaction, device, listing and communication signals to identify suspected fraud, spam, scams, account takeover, prohibited items, review manipulation and other abuse. We may restrict, suspend or investigate accounts in accordance with our Terms and safety policies. Where required, relevant data may be preserved for dispute handling, legal claims or lawful requests.

16.22 Changes to this Policy

We may update this Policy when our features, vendors, business model or legal obligations change. Material changes should be communicated through the Platform, email or another appropriate channel. The top of the published Policy should state the effective date and, where useful, a short summary of major changes.

16.23 Grievance and contact

Privacy questions or requests can be sent to [Privacy Email]. Grievances may be submitted to [Grievance Officer], [Grievance Contact / Address]. We will provide acknowledgement and handling processes consistent with applicable law and our published grievance procedure.

17. Incident response and evidence handling

Phase	Actions
Prepare	Named incident lead, contact tree, provider escalation paths, log sources, breach templates, evidence handling process
Detect	Security alerts, user reports, provider notices, anomalous access, data-exfiltration signals
Contain	Disable compromised sessions/keys, block malicious IP/device/account, isolate affected services
Investigate	Timeline, affected users/data, root cause, attacker actions, preserved logs, legal/regulatory assessment
Notify / escalate	Apply CERT-In, data-protection, consumer, payment-provider and contractual notification rules as applicable
Recover	Rotate secrets, patch root cause, restore clean data/services, monitor recurrence
Learn	Post-incident review, control changes, policy/process updates, user communication where appropriate

- Maintain chain-of-custody for critical evidence and restrict access.
- Do not “clean up” compromised systems before preserving necessary logs/snapshots.
- Separate security logs from ordinary analytics and protect them against tampering.
- Test backup restoration at intervals; a backup that has never been restored is not a proven recovery control.

18. Compliance roadmap and launch checklist

18.1 Before private beta

- Choose entity/founder structure and assign IP to the entity.
- Finalise core Terms, Privacy Policy, Prohibited Items Policy, Community Guidelines and grievance contact.
- Restrict transaction features to 18+ unless counsel approves another flow.
- Integrate payment provider; do not route marketplace funds through personal accounts.
- Implement baseline security: MFA for admins, RBAC, object-level auth, rate limits, secure uploads, audit logs, backups.
- Create vendor inventory and privacy/security review for hosting, email/SMS, analytics and verification.

18.2 Before campus-wide launch

- Lawyer review of e-commerce, intermediary, privacy, rental/storage and consumer terms.
- CA review of GST/TCS, section 194-O, invoicing and seller/provider onboarding.
- Pen test / focused security review and remediation of high-risk findings.
- Incident response exercise and admin-access review.
- Operational moderation/dispute SOP with escalation and evidence rules.
- If using campus space/logo, secure written permission/MoU.

18.3 Before rentals, storage and merch

- Rental: damage/deposit terms, replacement-value logic, evidence flow and insurance review.
- Storage: custody contract, facility/vendor due diligence, fire/security controls, prohibited items, declared-value rules and insurance review.
- Merchandise: trademark/logo permissions, quality/size/refund policy and manufacturer agreement.

> **Founder rule**
> Every time the product changes who owns an item, who holds money, who has custody, or who is the seller/service provider, re-check the legal and tax architecture. Those four facts drive most of the compliance differences in this startup.

19. MVP-to-scale implementation roadmap

Phase	Product scope	Security/compliance emphasis
Phase 1 - Campus network	Verified accounts, P2P listings, search, chat, requests, ratings/reports	Strong auth, moderation, prohibited items, privacy basics, zero hidden fees
Phase 2 - Protected transactions	Rentals, project hardware, services, payment integration, disputes	Payment webhooks, deposits, evidence, IDOR tests, finance audit logs, tax mapping
Phase 3 - Operations	Managed sales, storage, merchandise, club/business partnerships	Contracts per model, custody controls, insurance review, IP permissions, vendor risk
Phase 4 - Multi-campus scale	Cross-campus discovery, advanced trust/fraud, partner APIs	Tenant/campus isolation, scaling, SIEM, mature access reviews, compliance automation

20. Official references and review notes

[R1] MeitY - DPDP Act commencement notification (13 Nov 2025), G.S.R. 843(E).
https://www.meity.gov.in/static/uploads/2025/11/c56ceae6c383460ca69577428d36828b.pdf

[R2] MeitY - Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025, G.S.R. 846(E).
https://www.meity.gov.in/static/uploads/2025/11/53450e6e5dc0bfa85ebd78686cadad39.pdf

[R3] Department of Consumer Affairs - Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020.
https://consumeraffairs.nic.in/sites/default/files/E%20commerce%20rules_0.pdf

[R4] Department of Consumer Affairs - Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) (Amendment) Rules, 2021.
https://consumeraffairs.nic.in/sites/default/files/Consumer%20Protection%20%28E-Commerce%29%20%28Amendment%29%20Rules%2C%202021.pdf

[R5] CCPA - Guidelines for Prevention and Regulation of Dark Patterns, 2023.
https://consumeraffairs.nic.in/sites/default/files/The%20Guidelines%20for%20Prevention%20and%20Regulation%20of%20Dark%20Patterns%2C%202023.pdf

[R6] Reserve Bank of India - Regulation of Payment Aggregators / escrow account directions.
https://www.rbi.org.in/scripts/NotificationUser.aspx?Id=11996

[R7] CBIC - CGST Act, Section 52 (Collection of tax at source) and e-commerce operator guidance.
https://cbic-gst.gov.in/hindi/CGST-bill-e.html

[R8] Income Tax Department - Section 194-O, payments to e-commerce participants.
https://www.incometaxindia.gov.in/w/section-194-o-6

[R9] India Code - Majority Act, 1875, section 3 (majority at 18).
https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/15299/1/majorityact.pdf

[R10] MeitY - Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021 (official notices/updated rules page).
https://www.meity.gov.in/documents/orders-and-notices/notifications-on-information-technology-act-2000-its-rules-AOzATOtQWa

[R11] CERT-In - Directions under section 70B of the IT Act (28 Apr 2022) and related FAQs/extensions.
https://www.cert-in.org.in/Directions70B.jsp

[R12] Ministry of Corporate Affairs - MCA portal (company / LLP incorporation and filings).
https://www.mca.gov.in/content/mca/global/en/home.html

[R13] India Code - Indian Contract Act, 1872, Chapter IX (Bailment), sections 148 onwards.
https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/12845

[R14] IP India - Trade Marks Act, 1999 resources.
https://ipindia.gov.in/trade-marks-resources-act

> **Review note**
> Laws, tax rates, thresholds, payment-provider rules and regulatory interpretations can change. Re-verify the official sources and have an Indian lawyer and CA review the production documents immediately before launch and whenever the transaction model changes.

21. UniCirq brand and product identity

Finalized brand name: UniCirq. The brand is intentionally broader than a classifieds marketplace so it can support commerce, rentals, services, storage, student requests, local business offers and community utility under one identity.

Element	Decision	Product implication
Brand	UniCirq	Use across Student App, Business Portal and Admin Control Center
Primary tagline	Your Campus, Connected.	Communicates network/community rather than only resale
Positioning	Campus ecosystem / marketplace	Buy, sell, rent, learn, store, discover and connect
Launch unit	One verified campus	Prove density and repeat usage before multi-campus replication
Revenue philosophy	Low-friction student transactions; monetize higher-value services and B2B	Avoids forcing students off-platform to escape commissions

22. Role-based portals and login architecture

UniCirq should use one identity/authentication platform with multiple role-based experiences. A student, verified business and administrator may use the same underlying account/session technology, but the backend must route and authorize each role separately. Admin access must never be implemented by merely hiding navigation links in the frontend.

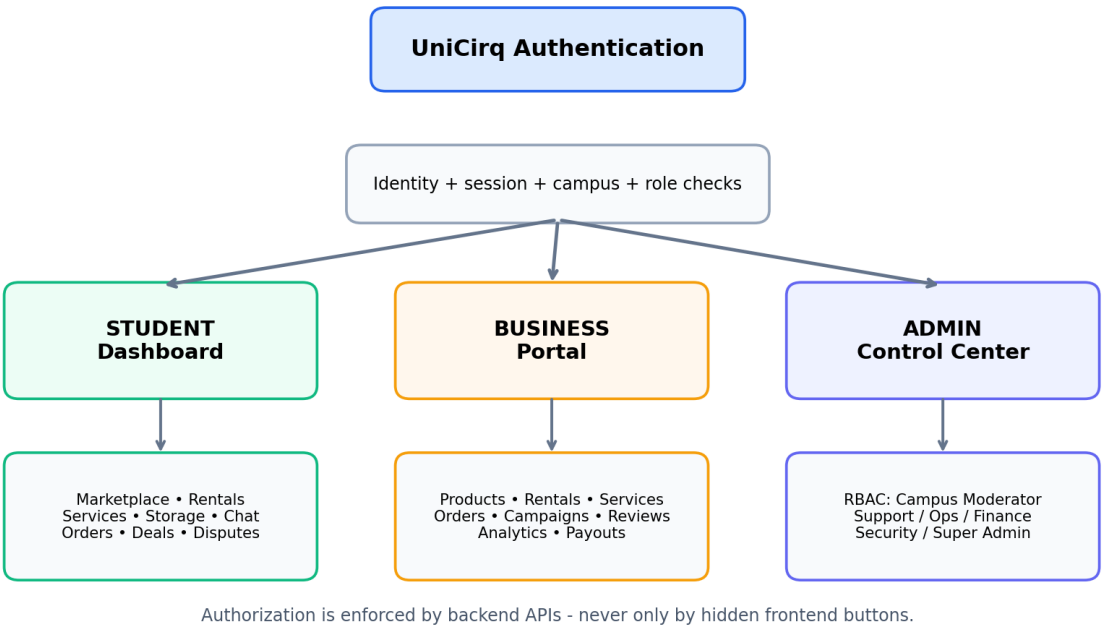


Figure 22.1 - UniCirq role-based portal and authorization model.

22.1 Student dashboard

- Marketplace, managed sale, rentals, project hardware, tutors/freelancers, storage, merchandise and campus deals.
- Requests, chat, orders, saved items, disputes, profile verification, trust/safety and wallet/payment status.

- Personal activity widgets: active listings, current rentals, service orders, storage booking and merchandise orders.
- Discovery surfaces: trending listings, verified campus businesses, seasonal campaigns and demand posts.

22.2 Business portal

- Storefront, products, rental inventory, services, orders and student inquiries.
- Promotions, campaigns, campus deals, ratings/reviews and customer analytics.
- Payout and settlement visibility, upcoming returns and inventory availability.
- Business verification and campus-scoped merchant permissions.

22.3 Admin Control Center and RBAC

Admin role	Typical permissions	Security requirement
Campus Moderator	Listings, reports, policy queues for one campus	Campus isolation + audited actions
Support Admin	Disputes, support cases, user communication	No unnecessary finance/security-log access
Operations Admin	Storage, rentals, merch, partner operations	Step-up auth for sensitive state changes
Finance Admin	Settlements, refunds, reconciliation	Dual control for high-risk finance actions
Security Admin	Risk events, auth logs, incident response	Strong MFA, least privilege, immutable audit logs
Super Admin	Platform-wide policy/configuration	Break-glass procedures, MFA, high-sensitivity monitoring

Recommended login pattern: students use the normal UniCirq login and are routed to the student dashboard; verified merchants are routed to the Business Portal; administrators use a dedicated admin surface such as admin.unicirq.com with mandatory MFA and backend role checks on every privileged API request.

23. Revised campus unit economics and seasonality

The earlier top-down revenue model was revised to reflect smaller student transaction sizes, lower rental margins and strongly seasonal usage. The base model below is an illustrative planning case for a campus of about 5,500 students after the product has established meaningful awareness. It is not a forecast or guarantee.

Domain	Usage assumption	Illustrative monetization	Annual revenue
P2P boosts	25 boosts/month x ~10 active months	INR 29 / boost	INR 7,250
General rentals	40 bookings/month x 8 months, avg booking INR 250	6% effective take-rate	INR 4,800
Project hardware	~100 bookings in each of 2 practical/project seasons, avg INR 300	7% effective take-rate	INR 4,200
Student services	60 jobs/month x 9 months, avg job INR 450	8% fee	INR 19,440
Managed selling	15/month x 9 months	INR 100 avg contribution	INR 13,500
Storage	~120 students x 2 breaks x ~2 months	INR 75/month contribution	INR 36,000

Merchandise	~400 units/year	INR 70 contribution/unit	INR 28,000
Local businesses	~5 advertisers x 10 academic months	INR 500/month avg	INR 25,000
Pickup/delivery	50/month x 9 months	INR 10 contribution	INR 4,500
TOTAL			INR 1,42,690 / year

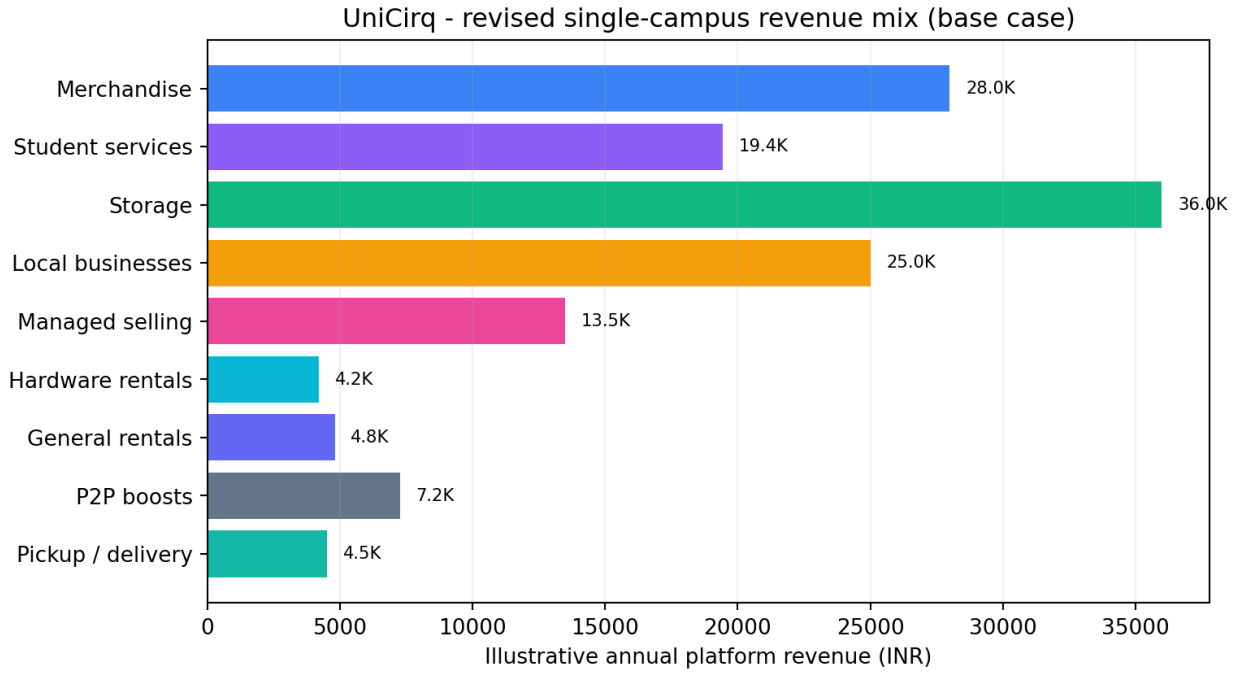


Figure 23.1 - Revised illustrative annual revenue mix for one campus.



Figure 23.2 - Illustrative seasonality; annual revenue is concentrated around practicals, events and breaks.

23.1 Why storage and hardware are seasonal

- Storage is likely to be used mainly around summer/winter or semester breaks, often for 1-3 months rather than continuously throughout the year.
- Project hardware demand is likely to spike around practicals, mini-projects and semester project deadlines - roughly two major demand windows per academic year.

- These categories should be marketed as seasonal campaigns instead of being budgeted as smooth monthly recurring revenue.
- UniCirq should avoid fixed warehouse or hardware inventory costs early; partner-led fulfilment keeps fixed costs low until demand is proven.

23.2 Revenue scenarios for one campus

Campus performance	Illustrative annual platform revenue	Interpretation
Poor adoption	INR 40K-70K	Useful only as product-validation signal
Moderate adoption	INR 1.2L-1.6L	Reasonable first-campus base case
Good adoption	INR 2L-3L	Strong local network with multiple monetization channels
Excellent adoption	INR 4L+	High campus penetration, business partners and strong seasonal campaigns

Strategic implication: Campus #1 is primarily a proof of density, trust and repeat usage. The scalable opportunity comes from reproducing the same low-fixed-cost software and operations playbook across many campuses rather than extracting large commissions from one student population.

24. Product/dashboard information architecture

The three dashboard experiences should share the same UniCirq design system but optimize for completely different jobs-to-be-done.

Portal	Primary user goal	Home-screen emphasis	Key risk to avoid
Student	Discover, transact, request and manage activity	Search, categories, trending, requests, orders/rentals, messages, trust	Overloading the home screen with admin/merchant metrics
Business	Sell/rent/promote and respond to students	Orders, inventory, campaigns, inquiries, reviews, payouts, analytics	Treating merchants like ordinary student sellers
Admin	Operate, moderate, protect and audit	Verification, moderation, disputes, risk, security, revenue, campus performance	Giving every admin broad super-admin access

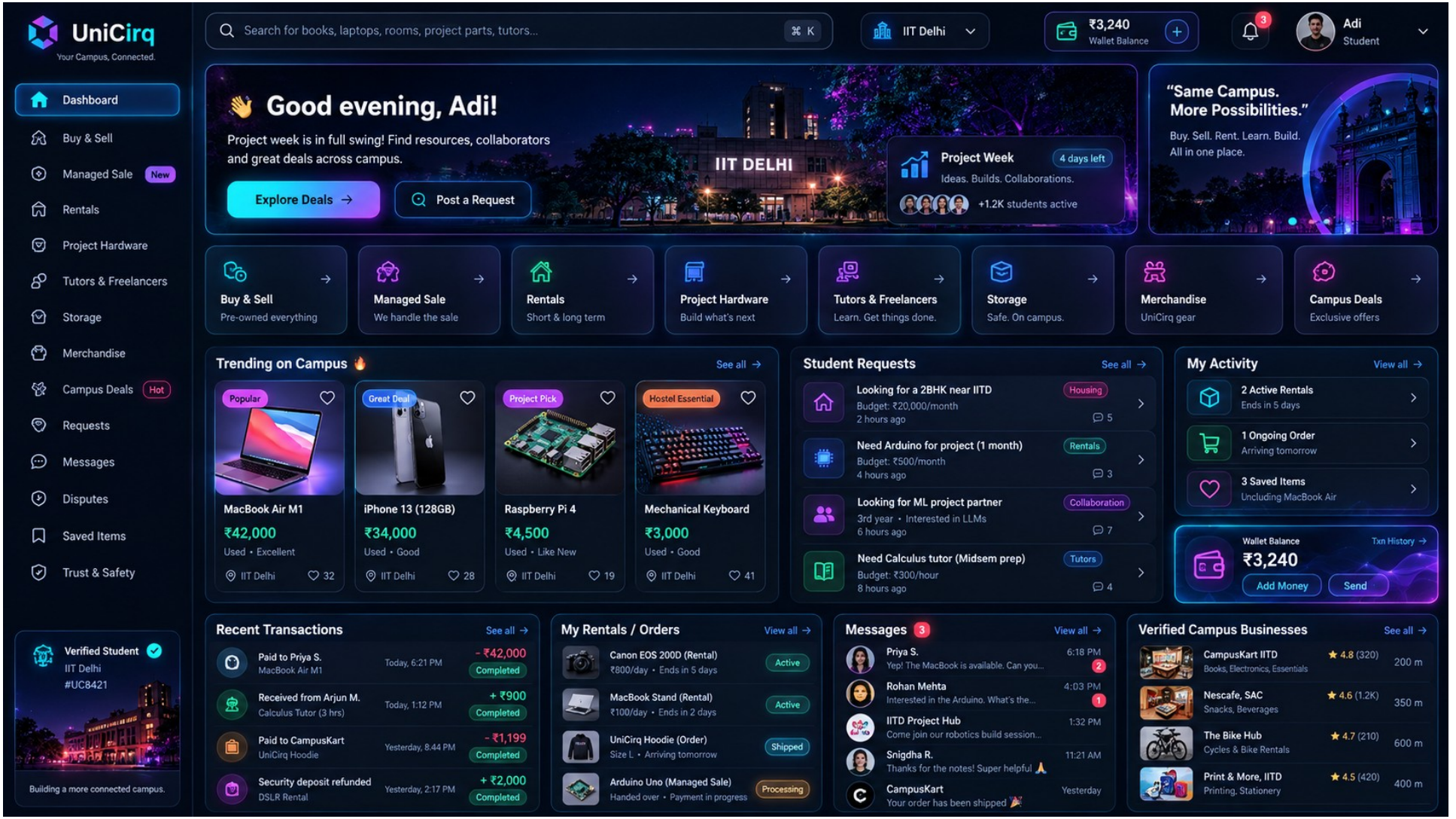
24.1 Shared platform components

- Shared identity, campus verification and role management.
- Search, listing/order/rental/service primitives with role-specific views.
- Messaging and notifications with access control at conversation/resource level.
- Payments/settlement integrations that avoid storing raw card credentials.
- Fraud, moderation, reporting, audit logging and dispute evidence pipelines.
- Campus tenancy/isolation controls for future multi-campus scale.

25. UI theme directions and dashboard references

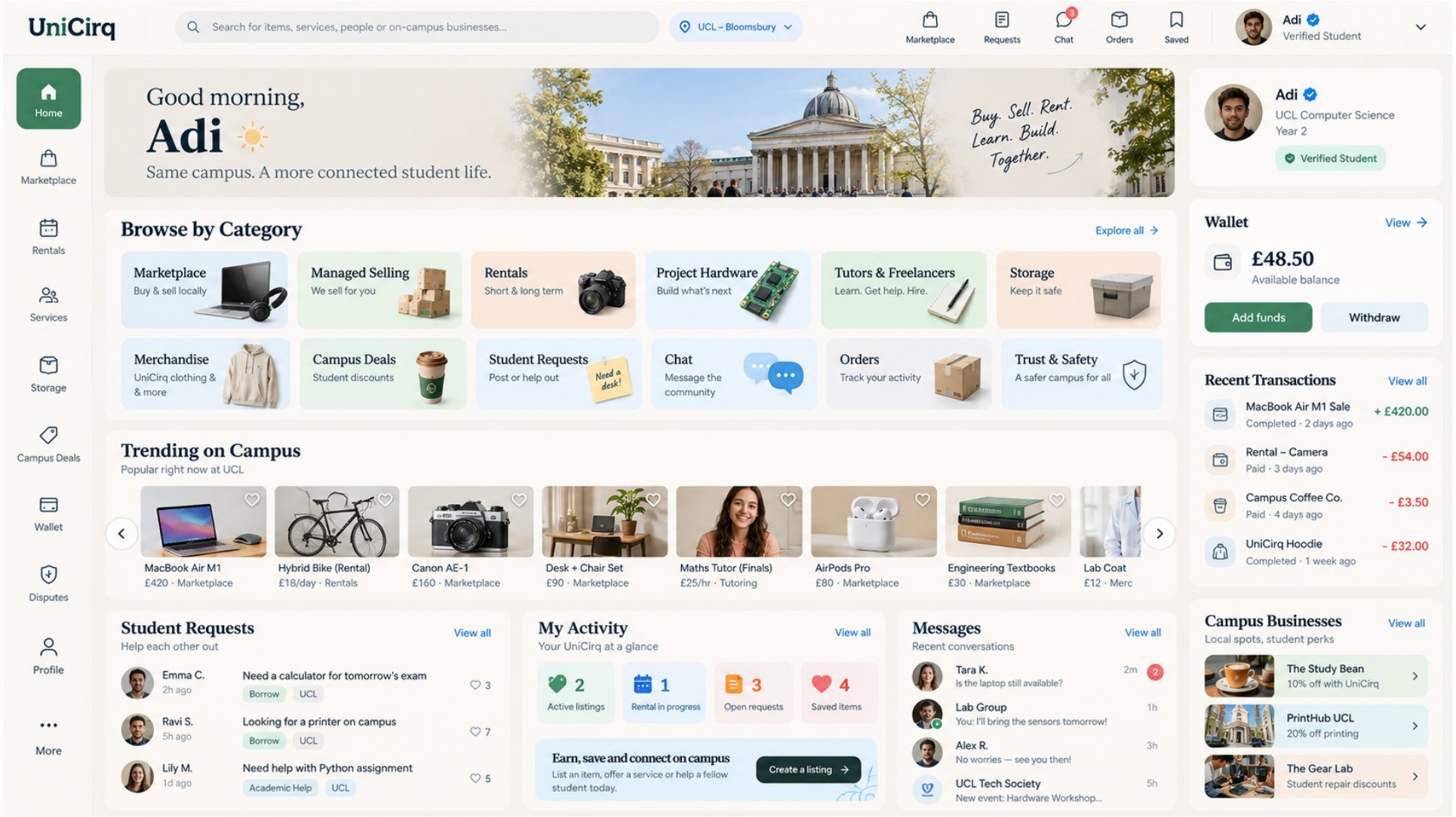
The following concepts are visual directions rather than final production screens. The final design system can mix elements from these options while keeping navigation, permissions and data architecture consistent.

25.1 Student theme A - Neon campus network



Dark neon/glassmorphism direction; highly differentiated, event-oriented and youthful.

25.2 Student theme B - Editorial campus lifestyle



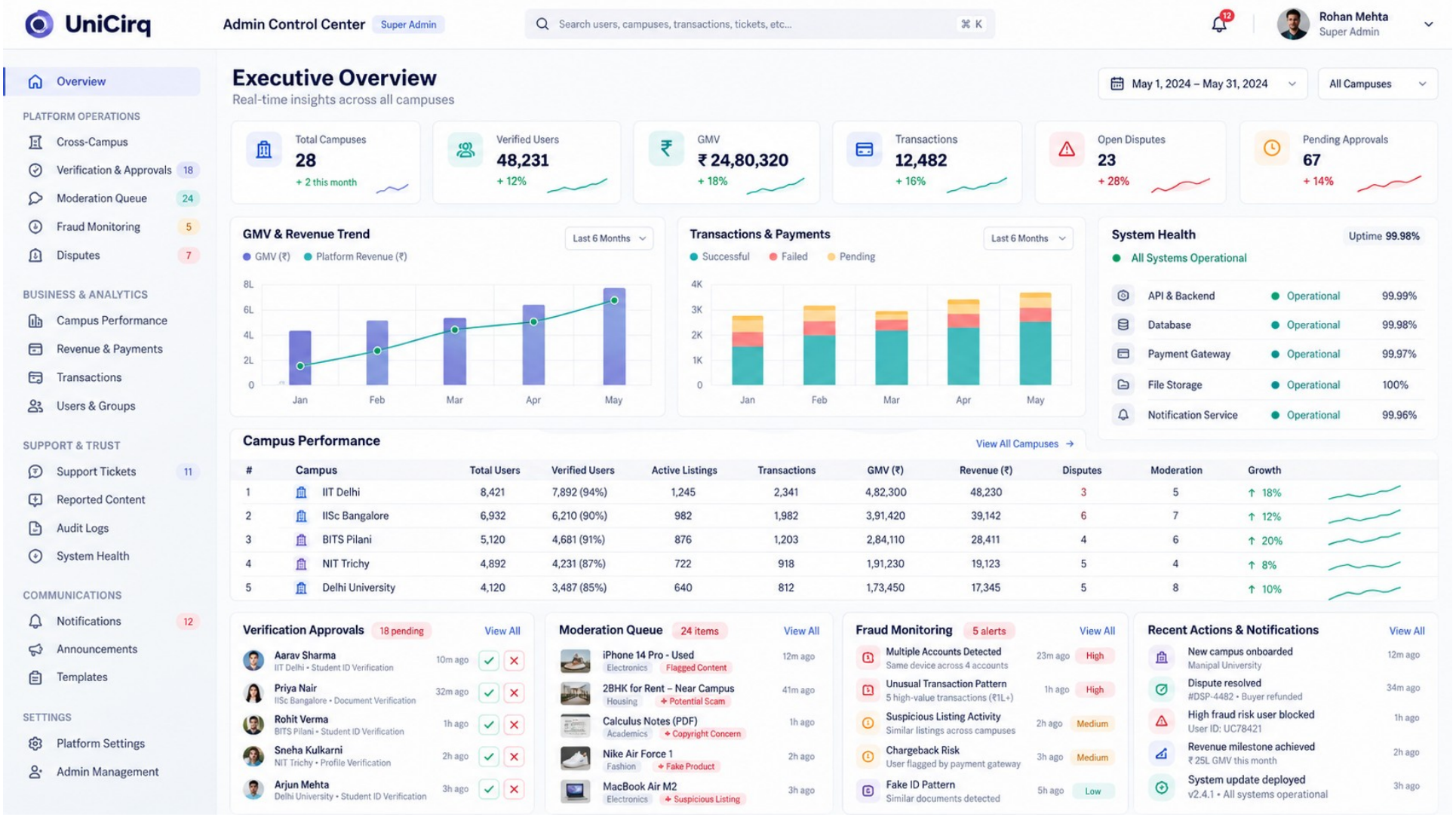
Airy lifestyle/editorial direction with softer discovery and community emphasis.

25.3 Admin theme A - Security operations center



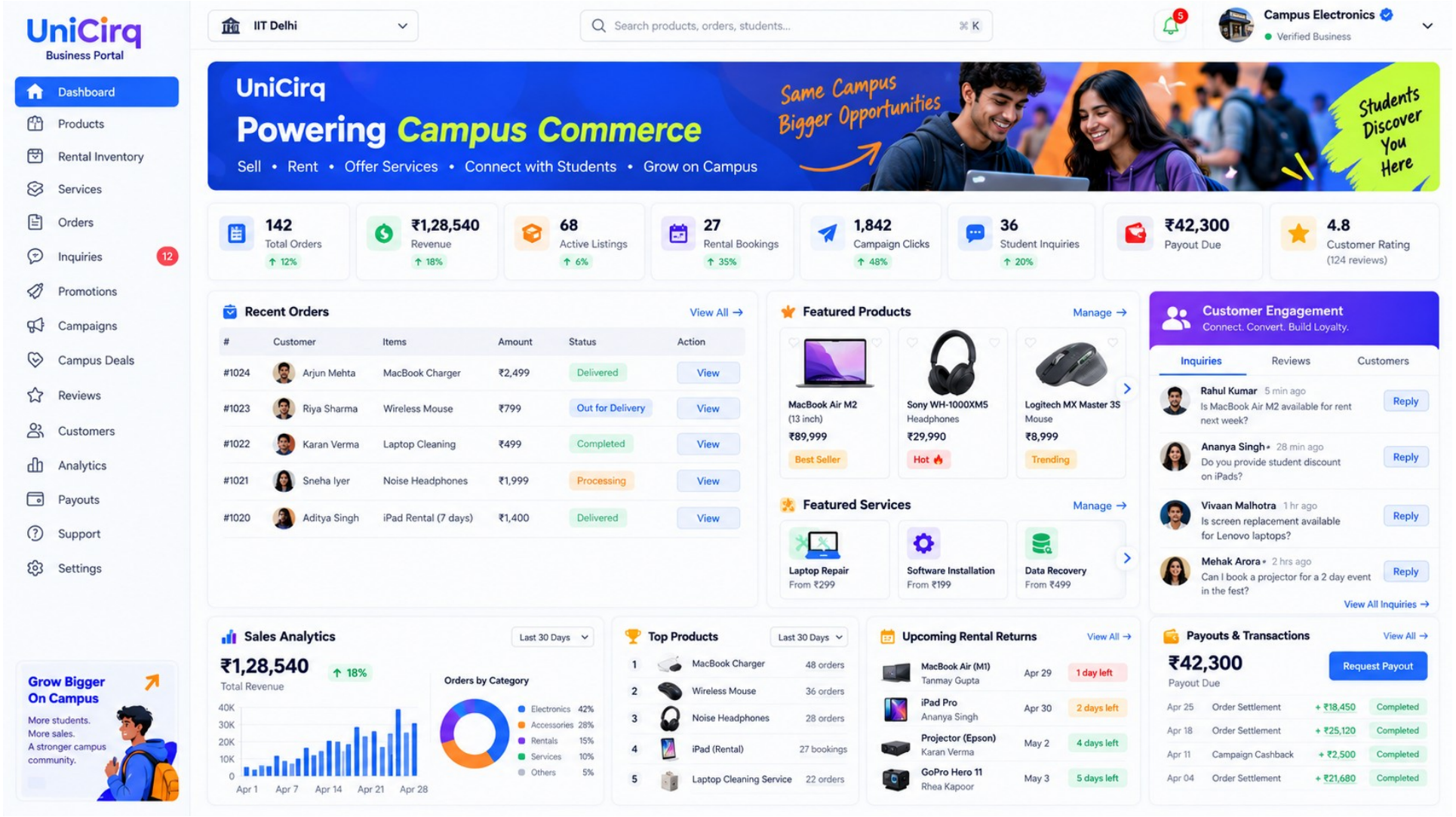
Dark monitoring-first control center suitable for fraud, incidents and real-time operations.

25.4 Admin theme B - Executive enterprise workspace



Light executive analytics direction with clearer cross-campus performance and workflow queues.

25.5 Business theme A - Bright campus commerce



Bright growth-oriented merchant workspace optimized for orders, products, campaigns and inquiries.

25.6 Business theme B - Premium dark merchant analytics



Premium dark merchant workspace focused on revenue, live orders, payouts and inventory.

26. Version 3 decisions and launch priorities

Decision	V3 position	Why
Brand	UniCirq - Your Campus, Connected.	Broad enough for marketplace + services + community utility
P2P pricing	Free by default; optional promotion	Avoids leakage and supports marketplace liquidity
Rental pricing	Small flat/protection fee or ~5-7% effective take-rate	Matches small student ticket sizes
Hardware	Seasonal practical/project category	Do not model as monthly recurring demand
Storage	Seasonal break-time service, partner-first	Avoids year-round fixed warehouse cost
Primary monetization	Services, managed sale, merch, storage campaigns, local businesses	Better economics than taxing low-value P2P transactions
Portals	Separate Student, Business and Admin experiences	Each role has materially different jobs and permissions
Admin security	Dedicated admin surface + MFA + RBAC + audit	Campus users may be technically capable attackers
Expansion	Prove one campus, then replicate	Multi-campus scale is the economic upside

26.1 Recommended immediate build order

- Student authentication + campus verification + role routing.
- Student marketplace, requests, chat, reporting and basic trust/reputation.
- Admin verification/moderation dashboard from the first private beta - not as an afterthought.
- Managed sale and student services after marketplace liquidity is proven.
- Low-fee rentals and project hardware before practical/project season.
- Business Portal and campus-deal products once verified student traffic is meaningful.
- Storage campaign integration before a major semester break; merchandise around events/fests.
- Advanced payments, settlement automation, fraud scoring and multi-campus tenancy as usage grows.

Legal note: the legal/privacy chapters in this document remain a planning framework, not legal advice. Final Terms, Privacy Policy, payment flow, GST/TDS treatment, storage/rental contracts and merchant onboarding should be reviewed against the exact launch model by appropriate Indian legal and tax professionals. The legal snapshot remains dated 27 September 2026.

Source review note: Version 3 retains the official-source references in Section 20. Current checks for this update were made against MeitY DPDP Rules/commencement materials, Department of Consumer Affairs e-commerce rules, RBI payment-aggregator/escrow guidance and Income Tax Department Section 194-O materials.